

Incident Report: inc-0003

Severity: HIGH

Detected by: Base64-Encoded PowerShell Command, LSASS Memory Access

Impact: Potential compromise of user CORP\alice's credentials on host WS01.

Host: WS01 **User:** CORP\alice

Matched scenario: credential_dump_chain

Raised: 2026-09-13T10:15:03.001Z

ATTACK CHAIN

1. 2026-09-13T10:15:01.200Z — Base64-Encoded PowerShell Command triggered (T1059.001): `cmd.exe` (pid 1280, parent pid 900)

Command line: `cmd.exe /c powershell.exe -nop -w hidden -enc SQBFAFgA...==`

2. 2026-09-13T10:15:02.123Z — LSASS Memory Access triggered (T1003): `rundll32.exe` (pid 4412, parent pid 1280)

Command line: `rundll32.exe C:\Windows\System32\comsvcs.dll, MiniDump 624 C:\Users\alice\AppData\Local\Temp\lsass.dmp full`

3. 2026-09-13T10:15:02.900Z — Process started: `rundll32.exe` (pid 4412, parent pid 1280)

Command line unavailable

INDICATORS

- Remote IP: `203.0.113.7`
- File: `C:\Users\alice\AppData\Local\Temp\lsass.dmp`

AI ANALYSIS

Note: generated with an older prompt version (prompt version unknown (predates version tracking)) -- may not reflect current analysis.

Summary

On host WS01, user CORP\alice triggered a credential-dumping chain: a hidden, encoded PowerShell command launched rundll32.exe to dump the LSASS process memory to a file in the user's Temp directory.

Likely Objective

Steal Windows credential material (password hashes/secrets) from LSASS memory for use in later lateral movement or privilege escalation.

Notable Details

- Command line used `-nop -w hidden -enc` to run base64-encoded PowerShell, a common obfuscation technique (T1059.001).

- rundll32.exe called comsvcs.dll MiniDump to write lsass process memory to C:\Users\alice\AppData\Local\Temp\lsass.dmp (T1003).
- Rundll32 (PID 4412) was spawned by cmd.exe (PID 1280), which in turn was launched by an encoded PowerShell, forming a clear parent-child execution chain.
- A network connection from the rundll32 process to remote IP 203.0.113.7 was observed shortly after the dump, suggesting possible exfiltration or C2 contact.
- Activity occurred within about 2 seconds, from 10:15:01 to 10:15:03 UTC on 2026-09-13.

Next Steps

- Isolate WS01 from the network to prevent further credential theft or lateral movement.
- Inspect the lsass.dmp file and confirm whether it still exists; preserve a copy as evidence before cleanup.
- Investigate the remote IP 203.0.113.7 (whois, reputation, any other hosts contacting it, firewall/proxy logs) and block it if malicious.
- Check for additional activity by user alice and the host (logons, other processes, scheduled tasks, persistence), and consider forcing a password reset for alice and any accounts exposed on that machine.
- Decode the full base64 PowerShell payload to identify additional commands, payloads, or C2 endpoints.
- Review endpoint telemetry and EDR rules for similar encoded PowerShell or comsvcs.dll MiniDump activity across the environment.

Caveats

- Triage verdict and confidence are model-generated and should be validated by an analyst.
- The re-triage timestamp (2026-09-28) is roughly two weeks after the incident (2026-09-13), so containment/detection actions may have been delayed; verify actual response timing.
- Network connection to 203.0.113.7 is based on a single 'network' edge linking events; confirm whether data was actually transferred.
- The encoded PowerShell payload was truncated ('SQBFafgA...=='), so the full command content is unconfirmed.
- No evidence yet confirms credential use or successful intrusion beyond the dump attempt.

AI TRIAGE

Verdict: TRUE POSITIVE **Confidence:** HIGH

Reason: Encoded hidden PowerShell spawned rundll32 comsvcs.dll MiniDump of lsass to temp file, a textbook credential dumping chain.

RESPONSE ACTIONS

Time	Action	Mode	Status	Result
2026-09-28T01:25:00.172Z	Would have stopped process 4412 (practice mode)	dry_run	issued	--